

Working hours and attendance

HOURS-01 | Policy owner: People Operations

Standard schedule

Cedar Lantern Works is a fictional company used only for RAG training. All policies, systems, amounts, and examples in this manual are invented. This manual contains no real employee information or confidential business data. Version 1.0 applies to this training scenario.

Working hours

Standard working hours are Monday through Friday, 09:00 to 18:00, in the employee's assigned office time zone. The unpaid lunch break is 12:00 to 13:00. A normal working day therefore contains eight paid hours. Saturday and Sunday are non-working days. In this manual, a business day means Monday through Friday, excluding company holidays.

Attendance records

Employees must record their start time, end time, and lunch break in the Time Desk system by 10:00 on the following business day. If a time entry is incorrect, submit a correction request to the direct manager within three business days. Include the affected date, the correct times, and a short explanation.

Overtime and late arrival

Overtime requires written approval from the direct manager before the additional work begins. Record approved overtime separately in Time Desk. If an employee expects to arrive more than 15 minutes late, the employee must notify the direct manager before the scheduled start time. A remote work day follows the same attendance and overtime rules.

Finding related procedures

Page 2: leave requests. Page 3: password resets. Page 4: remote work. Page 5: new customer contracts. Page 6: expense reimbursement. Page 7: IT security. Each procedure has a stable policy ID so retrieved text can be linked to its source.

Leave requests

LEAVE-01 | Policy owner: People Operations

Annual paid leave

In this fictional scenario, full-time employees receive 15 days of annual paid leave per calendar year. Employees can request a full day or a half day. The Leave Desk system displays the available balance. Employees must check that balance before submitting a request.

Request and approval

Submit an annual leave request in Leave Desk at least three business days before the first day of leave. Include the start date, end date, number of days, and a short handover note. The direct manager approves or rejects the request within two business days. Submission alone does not mean the leave is approved; the request must show Approved in Leave Desk.

Extended leave

For five or more consecutive business days of annual leave, submit the request at least ten business days in advance. The direct manager must approve the handover plan before approving the leave. The longer notice period replaces the normal three-business-day notice period. A handover plan must identify open tasks, upcoming deadlines, and the team role covering urgent requests.

Unexpected illness

If illness prevents an employee from working, notify the direct manager before 09:00 on the first day of absence, if possible. Enter a sick leave request in Leave Desk within two business days after returning to work. The three-business-day advance notice rule does not apply to unexpected illness. Do not include medical details in a team-wide message.

Changes and cancellations

To change or cancel approved annual leave, update the request in Leave Desk and ask the direct manager to review it again. People Operations handles missing balances and system errors. Example: a two-day vacation requires three business days of notice, while a six-day vacation requires ten business days of notice.

Password reset and account recovery

ACCESS-01 | Policy owner: IT Service Desk

Forgotten password

To reset a forgotten company account password, open the Company Portal sign-in page and select Forgot password. Enter the company account ID and complete the identity check using the registered authenticator. The self-service reset link expires after 20 minutes and can be used only once. Request a new link if the original link has expired.

New password requirements

A new password must contain at least 14 characters and must not match any of the last five passwords used for that account. Use a unique passphrase stored in the approved password manager. Never send a password, recovery code, or one-time authentication code to another person, including someone claiming to work for IT.

Lost authentication device

If the registered authentication device is lost or unavailable, contact the IT Service Desk through the Company Portal help form or the office service counter. Choose Account recovery as the request category. The IT Service Desk verifies identity using the employee record and a separate confirmation from the direct manager before resetting multi-factor authentication. Do not create a second account.

Locked accounts and support hours

Five failed sign-in attempts lock an account for 15 minutes. Wait for the lock to expire before trying again, or contact the IT Service Desk if access is urgent. Routine support hours are Monday through Friday, 08:00 to 18:00 in the assigned office time zone. Account recovery has a target response time of four business hours during those support hours; this is not a guaranteed resolution time.

Suspected compromise

If a password may have been stolen, report a security incident immediately using the procedure in SEC-01 on page 7. A routine password reset ticket does not replace a security incident report. Reset the password from a trusted device and follow the IT Security team's instructions.

Remote work

REMOTE-01 | Policy owner: People Operations

Eligibility and weekly limit

Employees whose roles can be performed off-site may request up to two remote work days per calendar week, Monday through Sunday. Remote work requires advance approval from the direct manager. A recurring arrangement must be reviewed every three months. Unused remote work days cannot be carried forward to another week.

How to request remote work

Submit a Remote work request in People Desk by 15:00 on the business day before the proposed remote work day. Specify the date, work location, planned tasks, and a way to reach you during working hours. The direct manager checks task suitability and team coverage. If approval has not been received, the employee should follow the existing office schedule.

Availability and equipment

Standard hours remain 09:00 to 18:00 with a 12:00 to 13:00 lunch break. Employees must be reachable through company chat and attend scheduled meetings. Use a company-managed laptop, enable disk encryption, and connect through the company VPN when accessing internal systems. Personal computers are not approved for company work.

Location and exceptions

Remote work is permitted only from the employee's registered home work location within the assigned country in this training scenario. Working from another country requires separate written approval from People Operations and the direct manager before travel. Requests for more than two remote days in a week also require approval from both roles.

Connectivity failure

If an internet outage prevents work for more than 30 minutes, notify the direct manager using an available communication channel. Agree on whether to move to the office, perform approved offline tasks, or record leave. Remote work approval does not automatically authorize overtime or the reimbursement of home internet costs.

New customer contracts

SALES-01 | Policy owner: Sales Operations

Required approval

Before starting a contract with a new customer, the Sales Director must approve the customer onboarding request. A new customer is an organization with no active customer record in the Customer Desk system. An informal agreement, verbal promise, or draft proposal does not count as contract approval.

Onboarding documents

The account owner creates a New customer request in Customer Desk. Include the proposed customer organization name, business purpose, service scope, proposed fees, billing terms, and the draft contract. Use only fictional organization data in training exercises. Sales Operations checks the request for completeness within two business days and returns incomplete requests to the account owner.

Legal and finance review

The Legal team must review every new customer contract before signature. The Finance team must also approve contracts worth more than USD 25,000 or contracts with payment terms longer than 30 calendar days. A contract worth exactly USD 25,000 with 30-day payment terms does not require this additional Finance review under this rule. Sales Director approval and Legal review are still required.

Signature and activation

After all required reviews and the Sales Director's approval, only the Sales Director may sign the contract on behalf of the fictional company. The account owner stores the signed contract in the approved contract repository and links it to the customer record. Sales Operations activates the customer record only after confirming that the signed contract is present.

Starting work and later changes

Do not begin paid delivery or issue an invoice until the customer record is Active. Changes to service scope, fees, or payment terms require a contract amendment reviewed by Legal and approved by the Sales Director. Finance must review the amendment if the revised total contract value or payment terms meet the Finance review thresholds above.

Expense reimbursement

EXPENSE-01 | Policy owner: Finance

Submission deadline

Submit business expense claims through Expense Desk within 30 calendar days of the purchase date. Each claim must include the purchase date, merchant name, business purpose, amount, currency, expense category, and an itemized receipt. Submit one claim line per purchase. A card statement alone is not an itemized receipt.

Approval thresholds

The direct manager reviews every expense claim. A claim totaling more than USD 500 also requires Finance approval. A claim totaling exactly USD 500 requires direct manager approval only, unless another rule requires Finance review. Employees must not split one purchase into smaller claims to avoid an approval threshold.

Meals and travel

The reimbursement limit for meals during approved business travel is USD 40 per employee per day, including tax and tips. Alcohol is not reimbursable. Standard economy rail or air travel is reimbursable when the trip was approved by the direct manager before booking. Home-to-office commuting and personal entertainment are not reimbursable under this manual.

Missing receipts and late claims

For a missing receipt, attach a Missing receipt declaration describing the purchase and why the receipt is unavailable. Finance must approve every missing-receipt exception, regardless of amount. Claims submitted after 30 calendar days require a written explanation and Finance approval in addition to normal approval requirements. An exception request does not guarantee reimbursement.

Payment timing

Finance pays approved claims in the next reimbursement cycle. Reimbursement cycles occur on the 15th and the last business day of each month; if the 15th is not a business day, that cycle occurs on the next business day. Complete all required approvals at least five business days before a cycle date to be included in that cycle. Otherwise, the claim moves to the following cycle.

IT security and incident reporting

SEC-01 | Policy owner: IT Security

Device and data protection

Use company-managed devices for company work. Lock the screen whenever leaving a device unattended and keep automatic updates enabled. Store work documents only in approved company storage. Do not copy company files to personal email, personal cloud storage, or unapproved USB drives. This training PDF itself contains only invented, non-confidential content.

Suspicious email

Do not open unexpected attachments or follow suspicious sign-in links. Use the Report phishing button in company mail to report a suspicious message. If you already clicked a suspicious link, opened an attachment, or entered credentials, also submit a security incident report immediately. Reporting a suspicious message without interacting with it does not require a routine password reset.

Incident reporting deadline

Report a lost device, suspected account compromise, or accidental data disclosure immediately, and no later than one hour after discovery. Use Company Portal > Security > Report incident. If the portal is unavailable, use the Emergency security reporting option on the Company Portal sign-in help page from another trusted device. The emergency reporting channel is monitored 24 hours a day, seven days a week.

Information to include

Include the time of discovery, the affected device or account, a short description of what happened, and any actions already taken. Never include passwords, recovery codes, or unnecessary personal information. Keep relevant messages and screenshots for the IT Security team. Do not delete evidence, reset the device to factory settings, or investigate another employee's account.

Immediate containment

If a device appears infected, disconnect it from Wi-Fi and wired networks and stop using it for company work. If a device is lost, report the last known location and let IT Security manage remote locking. If credentials were exposed, use a trusted device to reset the password as described in ACCESS-01. The IT Security team coordinates containment and tells the employee when normal work may resume.